

Social and Professional Issues

CHAPTER-3

INTRODUCTION TO ETHICS



What's Ethics all about?

- the study of moral principles that guide our behavior, focusing on what is considered **right and wrong**.

What's Moral all about?

- relating to principles of right and wrong, or to standards of **behavior** and character. It can also mean **expressing or teaching** a conception of **right behavior**.

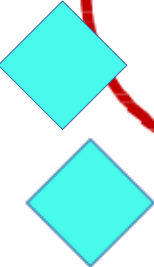
Difference of Moral and Ethics



Morals are personal beliefs about right and wrong, while *Ethics are rules of conduct that are generally agreed upon by a community.

What's Law all about?

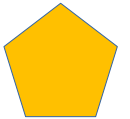
Law, in relation to ethics, is a system of codified rules enforced by a governing authority that aims to maintain social order by setting minimum standards of behavior.



What's Ethics in the business world?



refers to the **moral principles and guidelines** companies **follow** when making **decisions**, ensuring their conduct aligns with societal values.



“Essentially, it's about doing the "right thing" in business practices to maintain a positive reputation and long-term success.”



Ethical Considerations in Decision Making?

- involve evaluating potential actions based on moral principles like:

Justice- treating everyone fairly, giving each person their due, and upholding equality.

Fairness- treating everyone equally and given what they deserve based on relevant factors.

Beneficence- to act in a way that benefits others or perform actions that are positive and helpful to others.

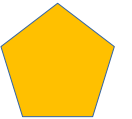
Non-Maleficence- means "do no harm" or to avoid causing harm to others.

Computer Ethics

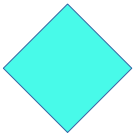
refers to the moral principles and standards that guide the use of computers and technology.

Overall, computer ethics seeks to address the challenges and dilemmas posed by the rapid advancement of technology and its impact on society.

Reason for Ethical Issues in IT?



due to the rapid advancement of technology, which often outpaces regulations and ethical standards.



Key Issues:

1. Privacy and Data Protection

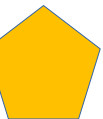
- Unauthorized collection, storage, and sharing of personal data.
- Data breaches and hacking incidents exposing sensitive information

2. Cybersecurity and Hacking

- Unauthorized collection, storage, and sharing of personal data. Ethical concerns around hacking, even for security testing (white-hat hacking).

3. Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Automation

- Ethical concerns about AI replacing human jobs.
- Bias and discrimination in AI.



Factors in Ethical Decision making in IT

Individual Factors

- * Personal Values & Morality
- * Knowledge and Awareness
- * Personality & Emotional State
- * Cognitive Biases
- * Moral Development

Group Factors

- * Company Culture
- * Leadership Behaviour
- * Performance Expectation
- * Ethical Codes and Policies

Theories in Ethics:

Golden Rule

- "Do unto others as you would have them do unto you."
- In IT, this means treating users, clients, and colleagues with fairness and respect.

Utilitarian Principle

- Actions are ethical if they produce the greatest good for the greatest number.
- In IT, this applies when designing software or security policies that benefit most users, even if some individuals experience inconvenience.

Kant's Cathegorical Imperative

- Act only according to rules that could be universally applied.
- In IT, this means establishing fair and consistent policies.

Descarte's Rule of Change

- If an action is not right for repeated use, it should not be used even once.
- In IT, this means considering the long-term impact of decisions.

Risk Aversion Principle

- Choose the action that poses the least potential harm.
- In IT, this principle applies to security decisions, software development, and data protection.

No Free Lunch Rule

- The idea is that nothing is truly free; there are always trade-offs and consequences.

Legalism

- Legalism can manifest in various ways, particularly concerning data protection regulations and software

Client/customer/patient choice

- It emphasizes the importance of allowing users to make informed decisions regarding their data, services, and the

Client/customer/patient choice

- these values ensures a fair, inclusive, and trustworthy digital environment, benefiting both users and the broader society.

Overview of Professional Relationships Between IT Workers and Others

- Relationships between IT Workers and **Employers**
- Relationships between IT Workers and **Clients**
- Relationships between IT Workers and **Suppliers**
- Relationships between IT Workers and **Other Professionals**
- Relationships between IT Workers and **Society**

Common Computer Ethics Fallacies

Computer Game Fallacy

- a misleading or incorrect assumption about a computer game
- the mistaken belief that playing violent video games directly causes real-world violence.

Law-Abiding Fallacy

- Where someone assumes that simply following the law automatically makes an action morally right.
- Blind Justice.

Shatterproof Fallacy

- The belief that a person's actions with a computer will only impact a few files, if at all.
- Pindot lang ng pindot.

Candy From a Baby Fallacy

- A situation where someone unfairly takes advantage of a weaker or more vulnerable party, using an argument or tactic that is so easy that it feels unethical.
- Repair shops or products selling at low price.

Hacker Fallacy

- Computers provide a valuable means of learning that will, in turn, benefit society .
- The problem here lies in the distinction between hackers and crackers.

Free Information Fallacy

- The idea is that nothing is truly free.
- refers to the mistaken belief that information, particularly in the digital age, is inherently free or should be readily available without any costs or restrictions.

Up next:

CHAPTER-4: Ethical Issues

